



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

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Let's Start!

Information is all over us!



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about relational database management system in spoken or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about information overload? Explain.
- Do you think information overload is more common nowadays? Why? Why not?

Can Do Statements:

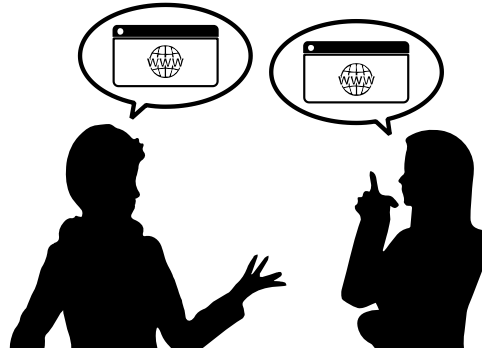
- I can talk about the concept of information overload.
- I can discuss the consequences of information overload.
- I can explain how to manage information overload.





Let's Explore!

Sophia is reading about information overload.



Instructions: Read the text below.

Marla: Hi, Sophia. What are you doing?

Sophia: Hi, Marla. I'm reading a very interesting article.

Marla: What is it about?

Sophia: It's about information overload, its consequences and how to manage it.

Marla: I see. I remember that information overload is related to the excess of information that we are exposed to constantly. Not all of the information is entirely useful, right? Do you think people are exposed to lots of useless information?

Sophia: Of course! Nowadays, information is everywhere. We are interminably flooded with videos, images, news, and people's opinions every time we look at our social media, or when we turn on the TV.

Marla: You're right.

Sophia: That's why there are consequences of information overload. One of the many reasons is that most people can't control themselves when it comes to surfing on the internet. They spend a huge amount of hours looking at their cell phones, playing games, or scrolling down in the news feed randomly. This provokes shorter attention, lower performances at work, and the feeling of being worn out.

Marla: I know that specific web sites are banned to make employees concentrate at work. I think it can have adverse effects; for example, they could lose essential information and rather get nonsense and unnecessary data. How is it managed in your workplace?

Sophia: Actually, the company doesn't have any restrictions against information overload.

Marla: They'd better hurry!

Sophia: I know! The company had better establish clear policies to avoid information overload and low productivity. Fortunately, I'm good at controlling my "addiction" to the internet.

Marla: That's good. Employees had better be great at handling too much information and excellent data managing skills. I think it's important that every person had better learn to stop distracting when they have to work. That is the first step!





Let's Practice!

It's ok not to know everything about everything!

Instructions: Classify the sentences by writing the number of the sentence in the correct category.

1. We have access to a sea of information.
2. No one is prepared to separate information.
3. We are inundated with information.
4. Employees are considered to be less productive.
5. Information moves 24/7.
6. People spend too much time on social media.

Causes of information overload	Consequences of information overload



Let's Practice!

Tips to manage information overload.

Instructions: Spell the mystery sentence. Move each word to place it in the correct order.

1. better / be / to / We / inundated / with / avoid / information. / had

2. task / time. / had / on / single / the / People / focus / better / a / at

3. managing / the / We / art / master / had / better / of / information.

4. the / skills / find / develop / had / to / People / right / data. / better

5. attention / data. / better / We / paying / stop / to / meaningless / had





Extension Activity

Let's educate people about information overload.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search for more information about information overload.
- Create a list of the most common behaviors that cause information overload.
- Create a poster using these behaviors and a possible solution.
- Share your work with the class.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

- I understand what information overload is.
- I describe consequences of information overload.
- I list behaviors and possible solutions for information overload.
- I share my work with my classmates.

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Target Words

- useless** (adjective): of no use; not offering any service
e.g. Do you think people are exposed to lots of useless information?
- interminably** (adjective): endless; constantly
e.g. We are interminably flooded with videos, images, news, and people's opinions every time we look at our social media, or when we turn on the TV.
- overload** (noun): an excess of something
e.g. I remember that information overload means the excess of information that we are exposed with constantly.
- provoke** (verb): to make someone do something
e.g. This provokes shorter attention, lower performances at work, and the feeling of being worn out.
- wear out** (adjective): to be exhausted
e.g. This provokes shorter attention, lower performances at work, and the feeling of being worn out.
- against** (preposition): opposite; facing
e.g. Actually, the company doesn't have any restrictions against information overload.



Learning Points

Simple Present Passive in Affirmative Statements and Questions

You use **simple present passive** when an action is done by someone on a daily basis.

When you are using passive, the object of the sentence becomes the subject. The tense of the sentence is showed by the verb to be (present simple in this case); and the action verb that comes after is always in past participle.

To form **simple present passive** in **affirmative**, you will need to follow the next structure:

Subject + to be (am, is, are) + verb in past participle

For example:

*Web sites **are banned** to optimize performances in companies.*

To form questions, you will need to follow the next structure:

To be (am, is, are) + subject + past participle

For example:

*Is your company **prepared** to handle information overload consequences?*

Remember that depending on the tense, the questions can have auxiliaries before the verb to be.

Examples

- *I remember that information overload means the excess of information that we are exposed with constantly.*
- *We are interminably flooded with videos, images, news, and people's opinions every time we look at our social media, or when we turn on the TV.*
- *Do you think people are exposed to lots of useless information?*
- *I know that specific web sites are banned to make employees concentrate at work.*
- *How is it managed in your workplace?*





Learning Points

Had Better for What Is Advisable

You use **had better** to give advice about in specific situations.

Had better is used to talk about actions people should do in the present or in the future.

To form had better affirmative sentences you will need to follow this structure:

Subject + had better + main verb in present + complement

For example:

*You **had better** start focusing at work.*

Remember the contracted form: **'d better**.

For example:

*They'**d better** be careful about banning web sites.*

Had better is more specific than **should**. That's why we use it only when we know that the result could be negative.

Examples

- *They'd better hurry!*
- *The company had better establish clear policies to avoid information overload and low productivity.*
- *Employees had better be great at handling too much information and excellent data managing skills.*
- *I think it's important that every person had better learn to stop distracting when they have to work.*